SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #52 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

"Things will never get better in this country."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Every generation has seen decline, and today's news cycle makes the problems seem endless. After disappointment with leaders and policies, hopelessness sets in, and we withdraw or grow bitter.

What Scripture teaches

Jeremiah told exiles, "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf." Solomon cautioned that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10). Paul urged "petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone—for kings and all those in authority." "Our citizenship is in heaven." Nations rise and fall, but God's purposes stand. Hope does not depend on any government, and neither does our calling to do good.

> *"Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper"* (Jeremiah 29:7).

Also see

> "Do not say, 'Why were the old days better than these?' For it is unwise of you to ask about this" (Ecclesiastes 7:10).

> "First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone— for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity" (1 Timothy 2:1–2).

> "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ" (Philippians 3:20).

> "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps" (Proverbs 16:9).

Common self-statements

- It is all going downhill.
- Nothing we do matters.
- The best days are behind us.
- No leader can fix this.
- It is hopeless.
- I want to give up on it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing the country is either great or doomed.
- Mind reading: Assuming everyone has given up.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling discouraged and concluding that nothing will change.
- Fortune telling: Predicting only decline.

Challenging questions

- What good is happening that the news does not cover?
- What has improved in history that people once thought impossible?

- What does Scripture say to people in hard places?
- What can I do locally that makes a difference?
- Where is my deepest hope placed?
- How is hopelessness affecting me?

Truth summary

> My hope rests in God, not in any government. I can pray for my nation, seek its good where I live, and do what I can. Citizenship in heaven frees me to serve here without despair.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Trust
- Worldly
- Will of God
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will never get better in this country"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will never get better in this country." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What good am I missing?
- ☐ What has improved?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I do locally?
- ☐ Where is my hope?
- ☐ How is despair affecting me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's purposes stand.
- ☐ I can seek the good of my city.
- ☐ I can pray for those in authority.
- ☐ My citizenship is in heaven.
- ☐ Good is still happening.
- ☐ I can do something locally.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Jeremiah 29:7
  "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 2:1–2
  "First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone— for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity."
- ☐ Philippians 3:20
  "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Hope in action: Each week, note one good thing you did or noticed locally.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Jeremiah 29:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will seek the good of my city and pray for it.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Limit the news. Choose a set time and stop.
- ☐ Do one local good. Serve a neighbor or a cause.
- ☐ Pray for leaders. Name them in prayer.
- ☐ Read Jeremiah 29. Notice the instruction to exiles.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will never get better in this country": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope in action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will never get better in this country.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am discouraged about our country. Anchor my hope in You, teach me to seek the good of my city, and use me where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.